

Maria Silva

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Dear Hiring Manager,

I am applying for the Paralegal role at NXTGEN because supporting solicitors on a complex and varied caseload is work I have been doing in practice, and I want to build on that experience in a dedicated legal team environment.

At Bryan Cave Leighton Paisner, I spent a year embedded in active disputes work. In the international arbitration team, I reviewed and organised evidence for a major investment arbitration, amended sections of the Claimant's memorial, drafted procedural orders and procedural histories, and became the only junior supporting the team in the weeks before a significant submission deadline. That meant tracking every outstanding action, coordinating documents across the team, and making sure nothing was missed under real time pressure. In the real estate disputes team, I prepared electronic hearing bundles, assisted with skeleton arguments, conducted legal and factual research across landlord and tenant and leasehold issues, and managed document-heavy matters with competing deadlines across several files at once. A partner and associate both told me my performance was comparable to a newly qualified solicitor, which I mention not to overstate the role but because it reflects the level of independent responsibility I was given.

Since then I have worked as a Legal Adviser at Citizens Advice East Berkshire, managing matters from initial client interview through to submission. I take detailed factual statements, identify evidential issues, draft correspondence and applications, and maintain confidential case records to deadline. The caseload spans welfare, housing, employment and debt, so accuracy and organisation are not optional; an error in a benefits application or a missed procedural step has a direct consequence for the client. That has kept me careful and structured in a way that translates directly to supporting solicitors on a busy caseload.

What draws me to this role specifically is the combination of varied, complex work and a professional environment where accuracy and proactive support are expected rather than incidental. My experience sits across document review, legal research, bundle preparation, file management and client communication, and I am ready to bring that to a team where those skills are genuinely needed.

Yours sincerely,
Maria Silva